

ALAN LAIRD

SYSTEMS ENGINEER | INFRASTRUCTURE DEVELOPER

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WORK EXPERIENCE

Lead Senior Software Engineer - Compute Technology Group

Akamai

📅 6/2023 - current 📍 Boston MA, remote

- Lead engineer in team of 20 building internal version of Linode that increased feature development speed, lowered development risk and led to rapid GPU deployment in the production environment.
- Bootstrapped cloud environment on KVM Libvirt and Ansible to provide first cloud platform
- Integrated internal services against large existing Salt base
- Drove service minded culture in software team

Infrastructure Developer - Engineering Shared Services

ViaSat - Leading consumer and military satellite Internet provider

📅 10/2021 - 3/2023 📍 Carlsbad, CA, remote

- SRE and DevOps roles maintaining customer-facing and global engineering core services and pipelines.
- Maintained and extended complex Ansible playbooks for system provisioning and service automation.
- Rebuilt and updated Ubuntu and CentOS real-time kernel build pipeline with El-repo and RT sources.
- Modernized monthly Docker releases for OS and platform pipelines.
- Created Ansible playbook managing a new jump box service in AWS for enhancing security as an engineering platform. Used Terraform for AWS VPC and AWS Security Groups and Jenkins for weekly rebuilds.
- Steered various Python components of Jenkins CI/CD environment.
- On-call support and troubleshooting for complex Consul and Syslog routing environments.

Systems Manager / SRE / Enterprise Systems Architect

Iovation - Anti-fraud as a service provider to Starbucks, FedEx and others

CAREER OBJECTIVE

Senior Systems Engineer with expertise in cloud automation, UNIX systems, and security, leveraging over 20 years of experience across startups and engineering environments to drive IT capabilities and operational efficiency.

EDUCATION

Computer Science

Southern Oregon University

📅 1987 - 1993

SKILLS

- Bare Metal and Cloud Automation
- Infrastructure as Code (Puppet, Ansible, Terraform, Packer)
- Systems Security and Audit Support
- CI/CD Automation
- Classic and SDN Networking
- High Availability and HPC
- Kubernetes (bare metal and cloud)
- AWS
- KVM, QEMU, Libvirt

CERTIFICATIONS

- ISO27001 / BSII799 Trainer - 2006

📅 2/2012 - 10/2021 📍 Portland, OR, remote

- Created and managed systems team, maintaining high 9s while rebuilding multiple datacenters of legacy Sun/Hitachi environment with Dell/Supermicro CentOS and Puppet-driven infrastructure as code. SAFe Systems Architect.
- Abstracted Cassandra and other customer facing systems and built new physical locations in Miami and Amsterdam. Added hybrid cloud patterns to support Asia.
- Improved SRE tooling for automation, monitoring, alerting, and Infrastructure as Code in Ansible, Terraform, and AWS Cloud Formation.
- Created monthly OS release cadence producing base OS Docker images with security patches.
- Built Kubernetes greenfield bare metal projects to test different High Availability and top of rack BGP patterns.
- Created Puppet managed KVM Libvirt virtualization platform to replace our VMware environment. Scaled out to 64 compute hosts supporting almost 1000 virtual machines, lowering cost and increasing delivery speed.
- Built and Automated MVP Docker versions of our product stack using Ansible on AWS, CoreOS and Kubernetes.
- Engineered 50 node OpenStack and Kubernetes environments with OS release pipelines in Packer.

Sr. SaaS Operations Hosting

Jive Software

📅 12/2010 - 2/2012 📍 Portland, OR

- Navigated complex infrastructure work supporting high-value customers in the Jive SaaS platform.
- Drove process creation to increase accuracy and throughput while onboarding staff and doubling team size.
- Wrote Puppet code managing large numbers of AWS and VMware virtual systems, networks and security.

HPC UNIX Systems Administration

Penguin Computing

📅 1/2010 - 12/2010 📍 Fremont, CA, remote

- Provided contract UNIX admin support for Bioscope genetic sequencing product.
- Managed bioinformatics customers on HPC Linux and Solaris clusters: TORQUE, PBS, MAUI, SGE, and LSF.
- Modernized and increased HPC cluster performance for NIH, Sorbonne and others.

Network and Systems Architect

Musician's Friend

📅 6/2002 - 12/2009 📍 Medford, OR

- Built hundreds of UNIX systems, SAN storage, datacenters and LAN/WAN networks including load balancing, firewalls and caching. Hired and trained staff and built practices and culture.

- Lead ISO 27001 effort and architected network and systems security controls leading to PCI Level 2 compliance.
- Architected networks and systems paving the way for massive operational capacity and efficiency growth, leading to 8x revenue growth.
- Lead effort to add Akamai global load balancing with layer seven traffic shaping rules and active website frames allowing stepped red, yellow and green style interactivity based on load. Rebuilt F5 stack and added alerting.
- Instilled ticket based workflows, engineering documentation and quarterly project review cycles.
- Modernized IT purchasing to lower costs and increase transparency.

IT Manager / Lead integrator for mergers and acquisitions

Maverick Networks / Broadcom

📅 11/1998 - 6/2001 📍 San Jose, CA

- Primary engineering support for startup, reporting to VP of engineering. Responsible for software tools, systems, networks, labs, facilities and managing contractors. Managed data feeds to partners and ISO9001 efforts.
- Built low cost and high performance Tatung Solaris compute environment and OS independent toolchain.
- Introduced LSF job scheduling and built a large data runout environment with data lifecycle accounting.
- Integrated software dev environments and labs for Broadcom's silicon valley acquisitions.
- Participated in SDK platform design and customer support. Advocated for programming interface compatibility with well-known ethernet parts leading to rapid development on VxWorks and Linux.

Engineering System Admin 4 / Engineering IT manager / Internet Systems Application Engineer

Silicon Graphics

📅 6/1997 - 11/1998 📍 Mountain View, CA

- Supported four labs, hundreds of systems, complex ATM networks and three teams of software engineers.
- Application Engineering - Test harness development leading to performance driven application tuning guides supporting Usenet NEWS server sales eclipsing all other UNIX vendors in 1998

IT Manager

Taos Mountain Software

📍 Palo Alto CA

- Led retrofit of 250K sq. ft. building in Santa Clara.
- Hired and led support team of three and built Solaris and Windows desktop and development environments on NCD X terminals.

UNIX and network admin

InfoStructure

📍 Ashland OR

- Built ISP startup, systems, networks and custom user and billing tools. Grew to 100s of modems, thousands of customers, partnerships with Southern Oregon University, South Medford school district and City of Ashland.

Tools software development

Trilobyte - The 7th Guest game

📍 Jacksonville OR

- Wrote tools and wrangled assets.
- Participated in game design.
- Supported partners with custom builds.